neobankbeat

monthly report · № 02

—— AUGUST 2026

the state of neobanks

379 verified-active digital banks, measured — custody, licenses, cards, stablecoins, geography and the fine print. Compiled from the open neobankbeat dataset.

379	260	61	58
VERIFIED ACTIVE	TRADITIONAL	HYBRID CRYPTO	WEB3-NATIVE

data as of 13 August 2026 · neobankbeat.com · open data, MIT

—— ABOUT THIS REPORT

Counting survivors, not press releases

The State of Neobanks is a monthly measurement of the digital banking industry, produced from the **neobankbeat open dataset** — a hand-verified directory of every neobank we can confirm as currently operating. Defunct entities are removed, not averaged in; unverifiable fields are left empty, never estimated. What follows describes the industry that exists, not the one that was announced.

What counts as a neobank here

A consumer- or SMB-facing, digital-first money app offering everyday banking — an account or balance, usually a card, payments — without a branch network. Three structural waves qualify: **traditional** fiat challengers, **hybrid** apps holding fiat and custodial crypto together, and **web3-native** self-custodial apps where the user holds the keys. Pure infrastructure (BaaS, issuer-processors), superapp payment features without banking ambition, and anything we cannot verify as live are excluded.

Method in brief

- **Sources:** regulatory registers (ESMA, EBA, FCA, NMLS, national registers), audited filings and IR disclosures, official terms-of-service documents, and provider websites.
- **Verification tiers:** 145 of 379 entities carry verified legal-document links; 170 carry verified official X handles. Fields that fail verification are null.
- **Reproducibility:** every figure in this report can be recomputed from `neobankbeat.com/data.json` (MIT license). The report itself is generated from that file.
- **Independence:** no affiliate links, no sponsored placements, no issuer relationships. Errors are fixed in the open on GitHub.

> CITATION
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Figures are compiled from public sources for comparison and research, and are not financial advice. Cashback and yield figures are "up to" headline rates that change constantly — always confirm with the issuer.

—— CONTENTS

In this edition

Entries are clickable — they jump to the chapter, in this PDF and in the web edition. Charts are generated from the dataset at build time.

—— EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Ten numbers that define the industry right now

4
SURVIVORS FOUNDED 2025 (VS 45 IN 2019)

30%
OF THE 2020S COHORT IS SELF-CUSTODIAL

2.7%
OF TRADITIONAL NEOBANKS SUPPORT STABLECOINS

26%
ARE ACTUALLY LICENSED BANKS

33%
SERVE A NAMED NICHE AUDIENCE

14
USABLE WITH NO KYC AT ALL

The founding boom that created this industry is over: among today's survivors, new-neobank formation peaked at **45 in 2019** and has collapsed to single digits. What replaced volume is structural change — the marginal new neobank is dramatically more likely to be **self-custodial** (30% of the 2020s cohort vs 4% of the 2010s), more likely to be **niche-first**, and near-certain to touch **stablecoins**.

Meanwhile the industry's centre of gravity sits where the marketing isn't: **Latin America, Africa and Asia grow the giants** (Nubank's 131M customers lead the entire industry), while Europe hosts the greatest density of players (144 active). And beneath everything runs the report's core tension: only **35% of neobanks are licensed banks** — the remaining **247** rest on partner banks, e-money safeguarding, crypto licenses, or no custodian at all. The gap between what apps imply and what their legal structure delivers remains the industry's biggest consumer risk, and its least covered story.

> THE ONE-SENTENCE TAKE
>
> Banking's interesting boundary is no longer bank vs fintech — it is custodial vs self-custodial, and every quarter moves more of the industry across it.

August in deltas

The series now has a baseline, so this edition reports the headline metrics **against July**. Net, the dataset moved from **357** to **379** verified-active neobanks — **28 added** and **6 removed** as apps launched, relicensed and quietly died. The mix kept tilting the same way: hybrid and web3-native both grew faster than traditional, and stablecoin support widened again.

METRIC	AUGUST	JULY	Δ	DEFINITION
Verified-active neobanks	379	357	+22	live and onboarding
— traditional / hybrid / web3-native	260 / 61 / 58	256 / 54 / 47	+4 / +7 / +11	wave split
Stablecoin support	121 (32%)	103	+18	any verified support
Licensed banks[1]	132 (35%)	–	n/a	charter holders
Partner-bank (BaaS) model[1]	81	–	n/a	rent a charter
Self-custodial (incl. MPC)	54	42	+12	no custodian exists
No-KYC apps	14	12	+2	zero identity checks
Niche-first neobanks	126 (33%)	–	–	named audience
Largest reported user base	WeBank · 400M	–	–	self-reported

[1] Regulation-type coverage was expanded and backfilled since № 01, so these two rows are not month-over-month comparable — the shift reflects more complete classification, not net industry movement. Category, stablecoin, self-custody and KYC deltas track real additions and removals.

WHAT MOVED

28 added · 6 removed since № 01. The full births-and-deaths list — with the cause behind every removal — is on the next page.

Why 6 neobanks died

A directory is only as honest as its removals. Neobanks rarely fail with a bang — usually an app just stops updating and support goes quiet. The 6 that left the active list since № 01 died three ways: a partner or rail collapsing beneath them, an acquirer switching them off, or a regulator pulling the licence. Who, and why:

A partner or rail collapsed beneath them

the defining risk of the rent-a-charter model: you die when your sponsor does

Fi Money IN · savings app · 3.5M users · ~$169M raised
Partner Federal Bank ended the relationship (11 Mar 2026) amid the RBI's tightening of bank–fintech tie-ups and thin unit economics; 3.5M customers were redirected to the bank's own app as Fi pivoted to AI.

Juno US · crypto-friendly checking + savings
Collateral damage in the 2024 Synapse/Evolve collapse: when Evolve Bank lost access to Synapse's ledger, customer funds froze across 50+ fintechs (~$95M went missing industry-wide). Juno wound down its Treasury account and pivoted to on-chain.

Kard FR · family & teen banking
Its e-money provider terminated the contract, leaving no rail to operate on — the company went into liquidation.

Acquired & switched off

not a failure so much as consolidation — the users move, the brand does not

Pomelo US · remittance + credit card, Philippines corridor
Acquired by Zepz (WorldRemit / Sendwave) in Jan 2026; the product was paused during integration and the team folded in — an exit, not a failure.

Z1 BR · teen neobank
Absorbed by crypto neobank NG.CASH; the Z1 brand was retired.

Liquidated by the regulator

the rarest and most abrupt: the licence is pulled and the doors shut

Will Bank BR · digital bank
Liquidated by Brazil's Central Bank (Jan 2026) — nominally for breaching Mastercard obligations, but tied to the collapse of the Banco Master conglomerate (a severe liquidity crisis and an ~R$11.5B fraud probe) that felled several linked institutions.

Sources are on each entity's profile; the running death log is the public changelog, and the deeper pattern is dissected in "why neobanks die" and the deposit-risk essay "who actually holds your money?"

—— JULY → AUGUST · NEW ARRIVALS

28 arrived this month

Verified additions since № 01 — community-submitted or found in our discovery sweep, then checked before listing. The pattern mirrors the whole dataset's drift: heavier on hybrid and web3-native, stablecoin-first, and increasingly niche.

AMP Bank GO · Always.bank · BFinance · Bitget Wallet · Blink · Brighty · Brookwell · COCA · Dolafy · Esh Bank · Flex · Flouci · Haventree Bank · Hyperbeat · Karta · Lava · Mine · Moto · PaySika · Plata · Slush · Solid · Sony Bank · Startale · SurfCash · Takenos · Tangem · Veera

THIS PDF IS A SNAPSHOT — THE PLATFORM ISN'T

Every figure here is live and updated continuously. Explore all 379:

- the directory · world map by country · sortable database · feature matrix
- the changelog — every add & death as it happens · the blog — a deep dive per chapter
- machine-readable: data.json · MCP server — point your AI assistant at it

—— THE TEN FINDINGS

What the data says

01 **The founding boom is over**

Foundings among survivors: 45 (2019) → 22 (2023) → 16 (2024) → 4 (2025, partial). "Another challenger bank" stopped being fundable around 2022; what raises now is niche underwriting edges and stablecoin-native architecture.

02 **A third of the new generation is self-custodial**

47 of 146 survivors founded in the 2020s (30%) are web3-native, vs 4% of the 2010s cohort. The industry's marginal energy has moved to the model where no company holds the balance.

03 **Stablecoins: 100% / 92% / 2.7%**

All 58 web3-native and 56 of 61 hybrids support stablecoins — but only 7 of 260 traditional neobanks do. That 2.7% is either a ceiling or the floor of the next migration. We think floor.

04 **Only 35% are licensed banks**

132 of 379 hold a charter. The rest: 81 partner-bank models, 48 e-money institutions, 53 self-custodial software, and a long unclassifiable tail. Deposit insurance is rarer than landing pages suggest.

05 **Cards are universal; the economics aren’t**

313 of 379 issue a card (182 Visa, 149 Mastercard programmes). 141 advertise cashback, 205 offer yield — nearly all behind "up to" tiers. Interchange-only economics are visibly straining.

06 Europe has the density, the South has the giants

Active presence: Europe 144, Asia 132, North America 126, LatAm 113, Africa 91. But the largest customer bases are all emerging-market.

07 One in three picks an audience first

126 of 379 serve a named niche — SMB (29), underbanked (21), freelancers (14), gen z (9), immigrants (9), kids (8), faith-based (7) and a dozen more. "Right bank for someone" beats "better bank for everyone".

08 No-KYC stays a rounding error — by design

14 of 379 are usable with no identity check at all; all are self-custodial wallets; none issues a card without KYC. The line is structural, not cultural.

09 Legal-link hygiene is poor

Official terms documents verifiable for only 145 of 379 — after an audit that repaired 60 dead legal links and removed 53 that resolve nowhere. For an industry holding money, basic document hygiene remains weak.

10 The categories are dissolving

Traditional players add stablecoin rails; web3-native apps acquire e-money licenses and IBANs. Our own three-way classification gets harder to maintain each quarter — which is itself the finding.

> REPRODUCE ANY OF THIS
>
> Every number above is a few lines of code against neobankbeat.com/data.json — schema in Appendix B.

01

—— PART 01

The landscape

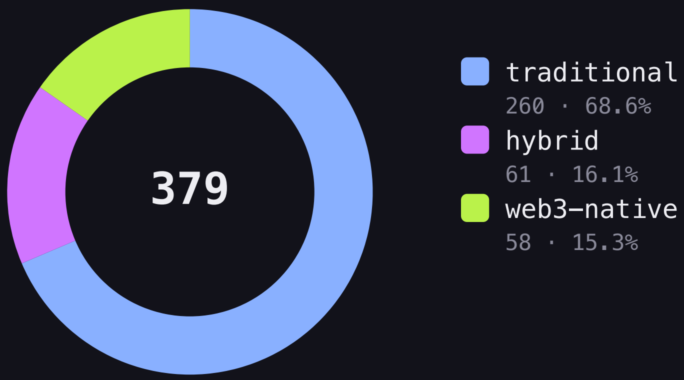
Taxonomy, history and formation: what a neobank is in 2026, where today's industry came from, and why the founding boom ended.

> The interesting boundary is no longer bank vs. fintech — it is custodial vs. self-custodial.

The three waves

"Neobank" is one word covering three different machines. The differences — who holds the money, what can freeze it, what insures it — matter more than any feature comparison, so this taxonomy underpins every page that follows.

379 NEOBANKS BY WAVE



Wave one — traditional (260)

Fiat money, custodial accounts, a card, and a regulatory wrapper that permits holding customer funds. From Simple and Nubank through the London cluster to today's licensed digital banks across the Gulf and Asia. Contains all the giants.

Wave two — hybrid (61)

Fiat plus custodial crypto in one app, arriving ~2017 from two directions: banking apps adding trading (Revolut, Cash App) and exchanges adding cards (Crypto.com, Coinbase, Binance). One counterparty holds everything.

Wave three — web3-native (58)

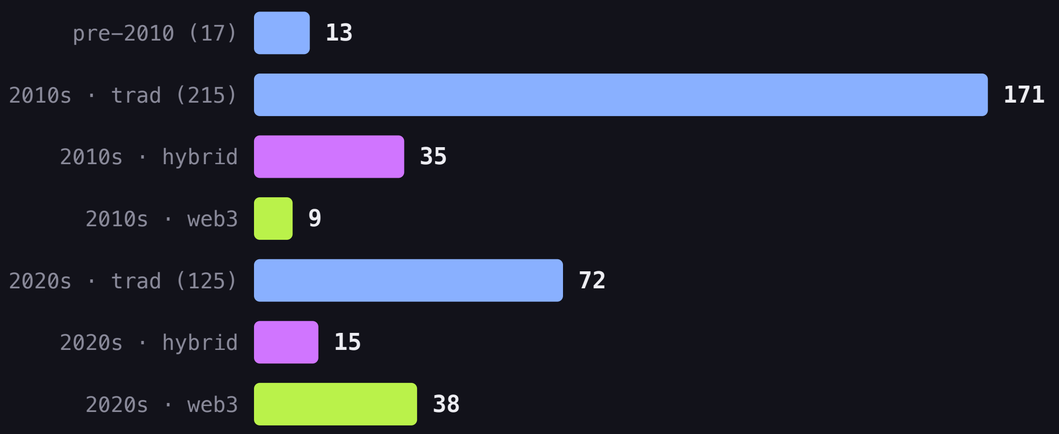
Self-custodial apps where the user holds the keys and the company holds nothing: wallets that grew cards (MetaMask, Phantom), and card programmes built on smart accounts (Gnosis Pay, EtherFi Cash, Payy). No deposit, no deposit insurance, no custodian to fail.

Same word, different machines

	TRADITIONAL	HYBRID	WEB3-NATIVE
Who holds funds	Bank or partner bank	The company (fiat + crypto)	The user (keys)
Balance is	Fiat deposit	Fiat + custodial crypto	Stablecoins / crypto
Deposit insurance	Usually (direct or pass-through)	Fiat sometimes; crypto never	None — no deposit exists
Main failure mode	Bank failure / ledger gaps	Custodian failure	Key loss, issuer or contract risk
KYC	Always	Always	Card-only or none
Stablecoin support	7 of 260 (2.7%)	56 of 61 (92%)	58 of 58 (100%)
Archetypes	Nubank, Chime, Monzo	Revolut, Cash App, Crypto.com	MetaMask, Gnosis Pay, Payy

Era mix: where each wave was born

CATEGORY SHARE OF SURVIVING FOUNDINGS, BY DECADE



survivors only — defunct entities excluded by design · source: neobankbeat dataset, August 2026

The 2010s produced a traditional-wave industry with a hybrid fringe. The 2020s cohort is a different animal: **web3-native is its second-largest wave**, larger than hybrid, and growing while overall formation shrinks.

—— DEFINITIONS

Twelve terms, precisely

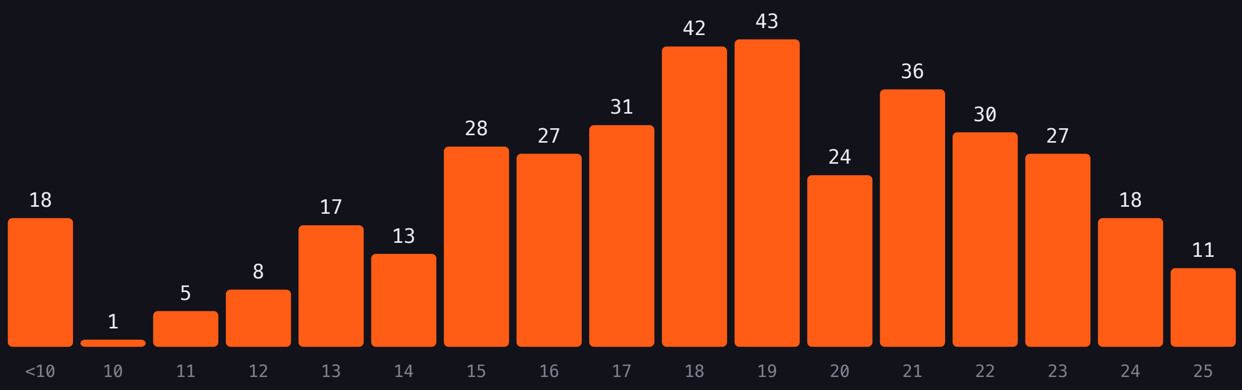
TERM	AS USED IN THIS REPORT
Neobank	Digital-first consumer/SMB money app: account or balance + payments, usually a card, no branch network
Verified-active	We can confirm the product is live and onboarding today; defunct or paused entities are removed
Custodial	The company (or its partner bank) legally holds customer funds
Self-custodial	The user holds the keys; the company cannot move or freeze the balance
MPC self-custody	Key split via multi-party computation — self-custody without a single seed phrase
Licensed bank	Holds a banking charter; deposits sit on its own balance sheet with direct deposit insurance
Partner-bank model	Unlicensed app fronting a chartered bank; insurance applies pass-through, contingent on accurate ledgers
E-money institution	EU/UK license to issue e-money; funds safeguarded in segregated accounts, not deposit-insured
CASP	Crypto-Asset Service Provider authorised under MiCA; passports across EU/EEA
Stablecoin support	Any verified support: balances, transfer rails, funding a card, or on/off-ramps
KYC: card only	The wallet is permissionless; identity is required only to obtain the card
"Up to" rate	Headline cashback/yield gated by tiers, staking, subscriptions or balances — not the typical rate

Wave colours used throughout: traditional · hybrid · web3-native. Orange marks findings and editorial emphasis.

—— CHAPTER 2 · FORMATION

The boom, measured from its survivors

SURVIVING NEOBANKS BY FOUNDING YEAR ("<2010" POOLED)



n=379 · survivorship-filtered: this is when today's industry was born, not gross founding activity · neobankbeat dataset

Read this chart carefully: it under-counts early years (more time to die) and the last two (not yet surfaced). Even so, the shape is unmistakable — a build through the mid-2010s, the **2018–19 peak (85 survivors in two years)**, a COVID dip, the 2021 bull-market echo (35), then contraction to **4 verified from 2025**.

Three eras explain it. **2013–2016:** smartphone banking becomes viable; the archetypes launch. **2017–2021:** venture abundance funds a challenger for every country and demographic; BaaS makes launching one a procurement decision. **2022→:** rates rise, fintech funding halves and halves again, and the marginal pitch shifts from "bank, but nicer" to products with a structural edge — underwriting a niche, or removing the custodian entirely.

> WHAT TO WATCH
>
> The 2025–26 cohort surfacing over coming months skews heavily web3-native and stablecoin-first in our intake pipeline — next editions will quantify it.

Seventeen years in one timeline

YEAR	WHAT HAPPENED	WHY IT MATTERED
2009–13	Simple, Moven, GoBank; Fidor in Germany	Proved a bank could live in an app — mostly on partner charters
2013–15	Nubank founded; UK mints Atom, Tandem, Monzo, Starling licenses	The two enduring models appear: LatAm scale and UK charter-first
2016–17	N26 gets a full license; Revolut adds crypto; Crypto.com & exchange cards	Wave two begins — fiat and custodial crypto in one app
2018–19	Peak formation: 85 of today's survivors founded in 24 months	BaaS turns launching a neobank into a procurement decision
2020	COVID; Kakaobank/jiban giants scale; Australia's Xinja collapses	First proof that licenses without economics don't survive
2021	Bull-market echo cohort (35 survivors); Nubank IPO at ~$41B	The category gets a public-market benchmark
2022	Rates rise; funding halves; FTX fails	Custody stops being a philosophical question
2023	Gnosis Pay ships the first self-custodial Visa card at scale	Wave three gets its archetype: smart account + card rails
2024	Synapse collapse strands partner-bank customers; MiCA phases in	The pass-through model's weakest joint fails in public
2025	GENIUS Act; FDIC recordkeeping rule; wallet-card wave (MetaMask, Phantom)	Stablecoins become supervised instruments; wallets become neobanks
2026	MiCA grandfathering closes; traditional-wave stablecoin pilots begin	The migration this report exists to measure

Deeper cuts on each era: the blog series at neobankbeat.com/blog, starting with "the three waves of neobanks".

The graveyard as evidence

This dataset's defining choice is survivorship: we track who is alive, and remove who is not. But the removals teach as much as the roster. Four failure archetypes recur:

License without economics

Xinja (Australia) returned its license and customer deposits in 2020; Volt followed in 2022. Both were fully licensed and adequately capitalised — the model failed on cost of funds vs. cost of growth, not on regulation. Contrast Up, which thrived inside Bendigo's charter, and Judo, which found profit in SMB lending: same market, different unit economics.

Middleware collapse

Synapse (2024) was infrastructure, not a neobank — which is exactly why its bankruptcy stranded end users of apps that were "FDIC-insured" in marketing copy. Insurance protects against bank failure, not against the ledger between you and the bank going dark. The FDIC's recordkeeping rule is the regulatory scar tissue.

Growth-stage abandonment

Dozens of 2018–21 vintage niche apps quietly sunset after Series A: the audience was real, the CAC advantage was real, but the deposit base needed to fund the roadmap never arrived. This is the tail our monthly removals mostly consist of.

Crypto contagion

Custodial crypto neobanks whose balance sheets or user trust didn't survive 2022 (and whose users learned the difference between an account and a claim). The lasting effect shows up in this report as wave three's growth: the market's answer to custodial failure was less custody.

> THE META-LESSON
>
> No failure archetype involves the product being bad. Neobanks die of balance-sheet physics, middleware, and funding weather — which is why this report spends its pages on custody, licenses and economics rather than app-store screenshots.

02

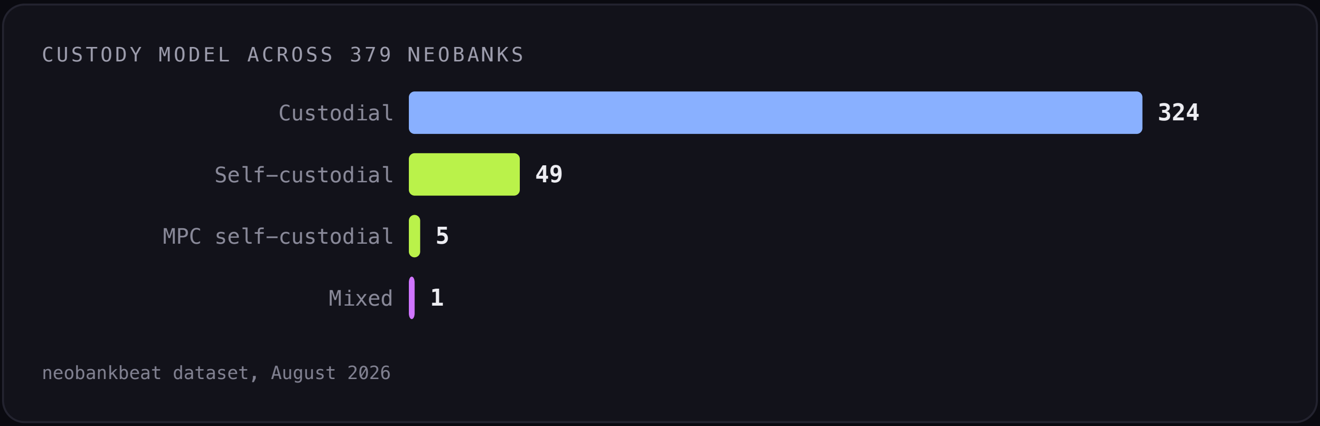
— PART 02

The machinery

Custody, licenses, cards, stablecoins and identity: the five systems underneath every neobank, and who actually holds the money.

> Feature comparisons are entertainment; custody comparisons are due diligence.

Who actually holds the money



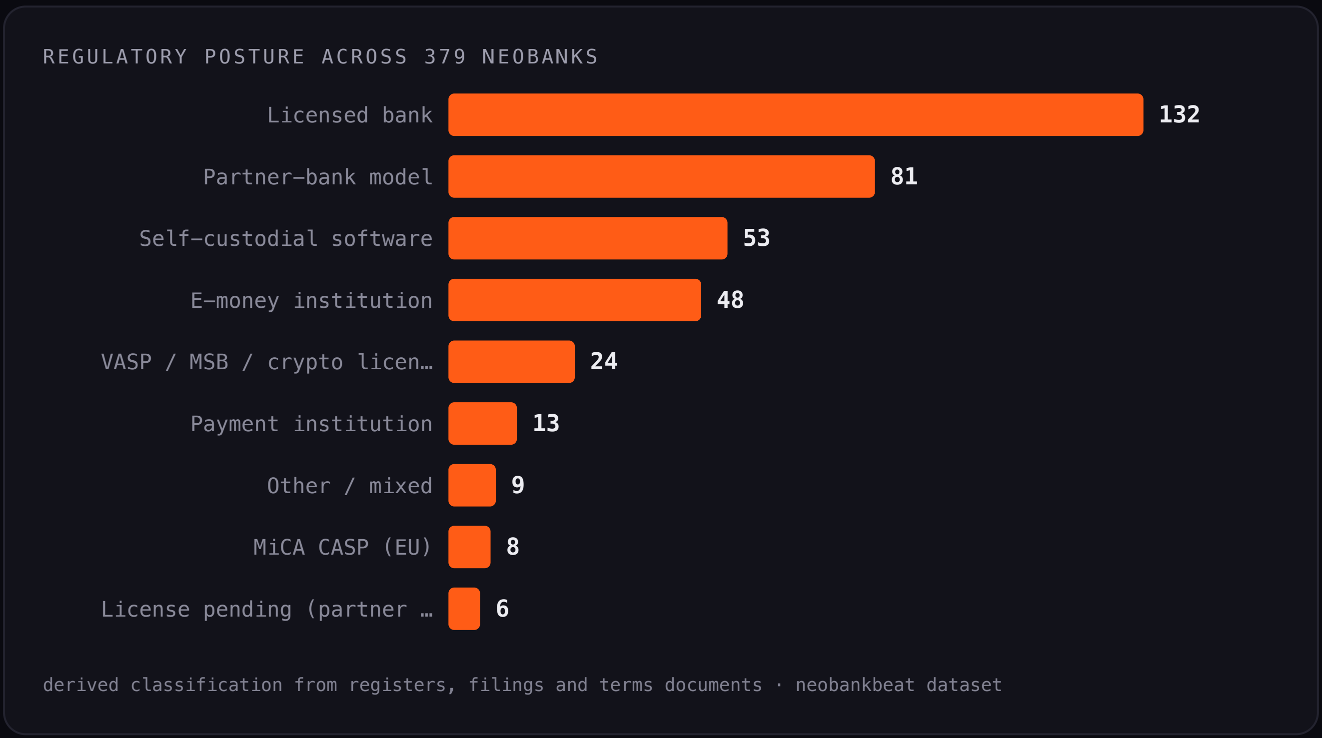
324 of 379 neobanks are custodial — a company (or its partner bank) holds the balance, and everything about your protection depends on which legal wrapper that company wears (next chapter). The **54 self-custodial** apps invert the model: keys with the user, meaning bankruptcy-remoteness by construction — a wallet balance was never part of anyone's estate.

The two MPC entries (threshold cryptography instead of a seed phrase) and the single mixed-mode entry are small in count but directionally important: they're attempts to keep self-custody's guarantees while fixing its unforgiving UX — the recovery problem is where this whole segment wins or dies.

Why custody is the report's spine

Every consumer question about a neobank — is my money safe, can it freeze, what happens in a bankruptcy, who can see my transactions — resolves through custody before it resolves through anything else. Feature comparisons are entertainment; custody comparisons are due diligence. It's why the directory puts the custody spectrum above the fold, and why this report keeps returning to one number: the share of the industry where **there is no custodian at all** — currently 14.2% and rising with each cohort.

The license behind the landing page



The single most consequential split in the dataset. **132 licensed banks** hold deposits directly with direct deposit-scheme protection. **81 partner-bank models** are technology companies fronting someone else's charter — protected on a pass-through basis *if the ledgers mapping customers to funds are intact*, which is precisely what failed in the 2024 Synapse collapse. **E-money and payment institutions** safeguard funds but carry no deposit insurance at all. **Self-custodial software** sits largely outside intermediary regulation — there's nothing held to regulate.

The large "unclassified" block is honest, not lazy: many apps' public materials do not state their arrangement precisely enough to classify without guessing, and we don't guess. That this block exists at all is itself a finding about industry disclosure.

The rulebooks that changed the game

MiCA (EU, phased 2024–25)

One rulebook for crypto services across 27 markets. CASP authorisation passports the whole EU/EEA — among tracked neobanks, Crypto.com, Coinbase, OKX, Bitpanda and Kraken's Krak operate under it. The e-money-token rules made compliant euro stablecoins (EURe, EURC) the legally clean settlement asset for European crypto cards, and pushed non-compliant issuance off European venues. Grandfathering windows have been expiring country by country through 2025–26; "operating under transitional measures" is a weaker claim than a register entry — ESMA's register is public, and every relevant directory profile links it.

GENIUS Act (US, July 2025)

A federal regime for payment stablecoins: full reserves, audits, redemption rights. It turned the largest stablecoins from regulatory grey zones into supervised instruments — the precondition for traditional neobanks (and their partner banks) to touch stablecoin rails at all. The 2.7% traditional-wave adoption figure in this report is best read as the starting line of the post-GENIUS migration, not its result.

FDIC recordkeeping rule (US, 2025)

The direct regulatory answer to Synapse: custodial deposit accounts must maintain ledgers that let the FDIC identify beneficial owners in a failure. It hardens the pass-through model's weakest joint — the bookkeeping between app and bank.

> THE CONSUMER TAKEAWAY
>
> Five questions before depositing: Who legally holds my money? Which insurance scheme, and does it cover *me*? Is there middleware between app and bank? What happens to the crypto side? Where does the yield come from?

"Is my money protected?" — the honest flowchart

IF THE APP IS A…	YOUR MONEY IS…	PROTECTED BY…	THE CATCH
Licensed bank	A deposit on its balance sheet	Deposit scheme, directly (FDIC / FSCS / national DGS)	Coverage limits per depositor; crypto side never covered
Partner-bank app	A deposit at someone else's bank	Same schemes, pass-through	Contingent on accurate app↔bank ledgers — the Synapse failure mode
E-money institution	E-money, safeguarded 1:1	Segregation, not insurance	In insolvency you're in an administration queue, not a payout schedule
Crypto custodian / CASP	A claim on the custodian	MiCA conduct & prudential rules (EU)	No deposit insurance anywhere; bankruptcy makes you a creditor
Self-custodial app	In your own wallet	Mathematics and your own opsec	No one to call: key loss, contract and issuer risk are yours

Regulation by wave

DOMINANT POSTURES INSIDE EACH WAVE

selected postures — full distribution on the chapter's opening chart · neobankbeat dataset

Each wave found its wrapper: charters and sponsors for wave one, crypto authorisations for wave two, and for wave three a split personality — unregulated software at the wallet layer, regulated e-money partners exactly where the card touches fiat. The perimeter is precise even when the marketing isn't.

The plastic layer

313 ISSUE A CARD	**182** VISA PROGRAMMES	**149** MASTERCARD PROGRAMMES	**66** NO CARD / WALLET-ONLY

83% of the industry issues a card — the near-universal bridge between any funding model and the world's terminals. The duopoly splits the market almost evenly (some programmes issue on both networks), with network choice driven by BIN-sponsor availability per market rather than ideology.

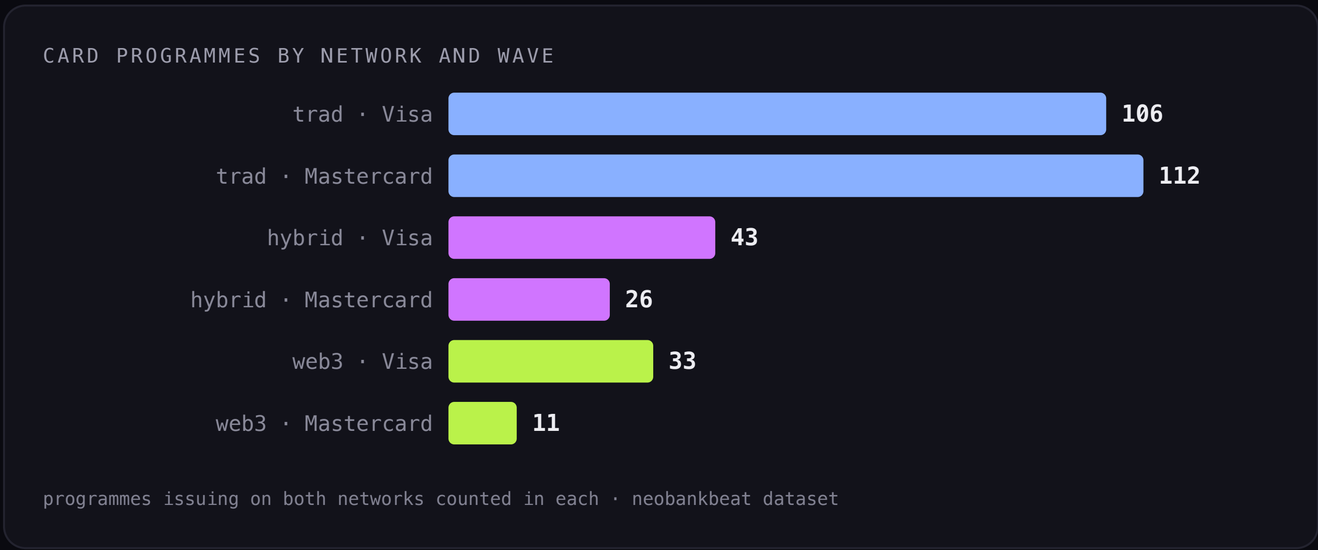
Rewards economics

MONETISATION SURFACES ACROSS 379 NEOBANKS

headline claims, not effective rates · neobankbeat dataset

141 programmes advertise cashback and 205 advertise yield — figures that deserve their permanent asterisk: nearly all are **"up to" rates** gated behind subscription tiers, staking requirements, token lockups or balance minimums. The pattern across waves is consistent: interchange alone no longer funds a free account, so monetisation has moved to subscriptions, FX spread, yield share and — in the crypto waves — token economics. When a card pays 4% back, the sustainable question is always: from what?

Network split by wave



The interesting row is the bottom pair: **the card networks are the reason wave three exists as a consumer product.** A self-custodial balance is an island until a BIN sponsor connects it to 130M+ terminals — and both networks, having watched wallets accumulate users, now compete for exactly these programmes (including direct USDC settlement with crypto-native issuers). The duopoly's neutrality between waves is one of the industry's least appreciated structural facts.

Anatomy of a "free" account

REVENUE LINE	WHO PAYS	WHERE IT SHOWS IN THE DATA
Interchange	Merchants, per swipe	313 card programmes — the default engine
Subscriptions	Users, monthly	premium tiers gating the best of 141 cashback offers
FX & spread	Travellers, remitters, traders	crypto conversion spreads across the 119 crypto-touching apps
Yield share	Balance float / DeFi protocols	205 yield offers — margin lives between earned and passed-through
Token economics	Token holders	staking-gated tiers (CRO archetype) in the hybrid wave
Credit	Borrowers	the endgame: every giant in Ch. 9 lends or is building lending

The 2.7% that will define the decade

STABLECOIN SUPPORT BY WAVE

any stablecoin support: balances, rails, cards or transfers · neobankbeat dataset

Adoption is total in wave three (100%), near-total in wave two (92%) — and **2.7% in the wave that has the users**. That asymmetry is the most important strategic fact in this report. Stablecoin capability is table stakes where it's easy and existential where it's hard: a traditional neobank adding stablecoin rails must answer custody, licensing, accounting and banking-partner questions that a wallet never faces.

Why we read 2.7% as a floor: GENIUS and MiCA turned the instruments into supervised, fully-reserved assets; the card networks now settle directly in USDC with crypto-native issuers; and the commercial prize — instant, global, programmable dollars attached to existing user bases of tens of millions — is the largest unclaimed feature in consumer fintech. Each traditional player that flips the switch moves more users onto stablecoin rails in a week than the web3-native wave has acquired in total. *(Reading, not fact — flagged accordingly.)*

WATCH NEXT MONTH

We track announcements vs verified launches separately — the gap between "plans stablecoin support" press releases and live rails is where this migration's real pace shows.

The instruments, sorted by rulebook

INSTRUMENT	REGIME	ROLE IN THE NEOBANK STACK
USDC	GENIUS-aligned (US); MiCA EMT via EU entity	Default settlement asset for compliant card programmes; direct network settlement live
USDT	Offshore; delisted from MiCA-regulated EU venues	Still the emerging-market street dollar — dominant in the LatAm/Africa dollar-account apps
EURe / EURC	MiCA e-money tokens	The legally clean euro rail — EURe settles Gnosis Pay, the archetype self-custodial card
PYUSD, bank coins	GENIUS-era issuance	Distribution plays: existing fintech user bases handed a native dollar token
Yield-bearing dollars (sUSDe et al.)	Varies; generally not "payment stablecoins"	The yield engine behind several web3-native cards — highest yield, most moving parts

What stablecoins actually fix

Strip the ideology and stablecoins solve four concrete product problems visible across the dataset: **weekend money** (24/7 settlement vs banking hours), **cross-border payroll and remittance** (the immigrant-banking niche is converging on stablecoin rails from both directions), **inflation refuge** (the LatAm dollar-account category — DolarApp, El Dorado, Lemon — is functionally a stablecoin wrapper with a card), and **programmability** (spending rules enforced by contract rather than policy, which is also what makes agent wallets possible).

What they don't fix: deposit insurance (a stablecoin is a claim on reserves, not an insured deposit), and consumer-grade recovery (still the UX frontier of chapter 4). The honest framing for a neobank user: stablecoins trade bank-failure risk and border friction for issuer risk and key management. Different risks — not no risks.

The 14 apps that never ask your name

Exactly **14 of 379** tracked neobanks operate without identity checks — 3.7% of the industry. All are self-custodial. None issues a card without KYC. A further **33** are "card-only" KYC: permissionless wallet, identified cardholder.

APP	HQ	EST.	WHAT IT IS
Eco (Beam)	New York, US	2023	Self-custodial dollars; Eco protocol.
Phantom	San Francisco, US	2021	Solana-first multichain wallet; 15M+ users.
Rainbow	New York, US	2019	Open-source EVM wallet; Ledger/Trezor.
Xverse	London, UK	2021	Bitcoin-native: ordinals, Stacks, Lightning.
Trust Wallet	—	2017	140M+ installs; Binance-linked self-custody.
Exodus	Omaha, US	2015	Public-company self-custody wallet (NYSE American).
Zengo	Tel Aviv, IL	2018	MPC wallet, no seed phrase; acquired by eToro (Apr 2026).
MiniPay	Oslo, NO	2023	Opera's Celo wallet; 10M+; PIX/Mercado Pago rails.
Peanut	Zug, CH	2022	Claim-link crypto transfers; open protocol.
Moon	—	2022	Privacy-lean virtual cards funded with crypto.
SurfCash	—	2025	USDC → VietQR/PromptPay/PIX in ~10s; 0.5% fee; the rails cards can't touch.
Daimo	New York, US	2023	Open-source self-custodial USDC wallet.
Superform	—	2023	Self-custodial onchain yield 'savings account'.
Slush	Palo Alto, US	2021	Official self-custodial Sui wallet by Mysten Labs (formerly Sui Wallet, merged w

The line is structural: KYC obligations attach to regulated intermediaries — entities holding, transmitting or exchanging customer funds. Pure software that never touches funds is largely outside that perimeter; everything touching fiat (cards, IBANs, ramps) is inside it, no exceptions that survive contact with a card network. The honest use cases are undocumented populations, capital-controlled economies, privacy-principled users accepting the trade-offs, and — increasingly — software agents that can hold a key but cannot pass a selfie check.

The customer that can't pass KYC: software

The strangest implication of the permissionless segment isn't human privacy — it's that **software agents are becoming account holders**. An AI agent can generate a key, hold a stablecoin balance in a smart account, and spend against contract-enforced limits. It cannot photograph a passport. Every regulated onboarding flow in the other 365 neobanks is, by construction, closed to it.

This is why the no-KYC column matters beyond its 3.7% share: it is the only corner of the industry where machine customers are structurally possible today. The building blocks are already in the dataset — self-custodial smart accounts (chapter 4), programmable spending permissions, stablecoin settlement (chapter 7), and card rails that terminate in an identified human sponsor while the wallet itself stays permissionless.

> OUR READING — FLAGGED AS SPECULATION
>
> Agent payments will force the first serious rethink of "know your customer" since its inception: the useful question becomes "know your *controller*" — which human or entity is accountable for a key — and the first mainstream controversy is likelier to involve an agent's spending than a human's privacy.

Where the line will move

Two pressures point in opposite directions. Regulators keep extending the perimeter (MiCA's transfer-rule requirements, travel-rule enforcement) — pushing identification deeper into crypto rails. Meanwhile passkey wallets and account abstraction keep lowering the cost of being permissionless. The dataset's card-only KYC bucket (33 apps) is where the two forces currently settle: identity where fiat touches, freedom where it doesn't. Expect that bucket, not the pure no-KYC one, to grow.

03

—— PART 03

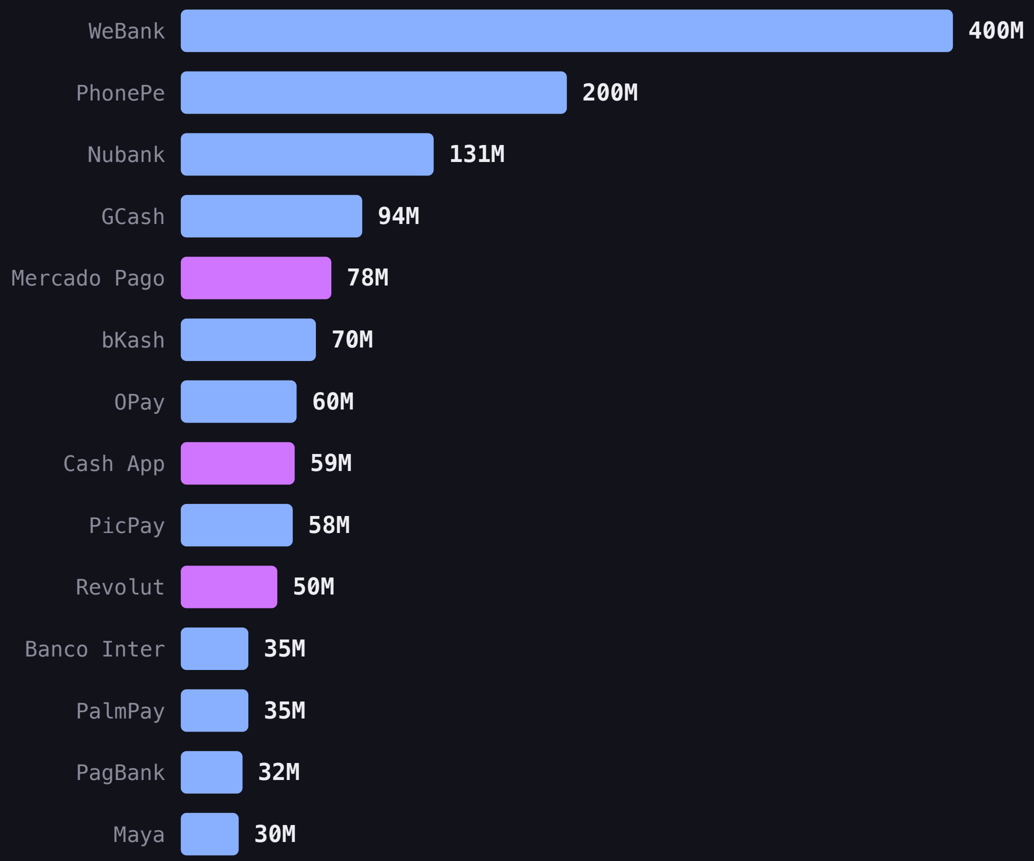
The map

Scale, geography and niches: where the users are, how seven regional playbooks differ, and why a third of the industry picks an audience before a product.

> Scale in this industry has never been won on interface polish — it is won on distribution the incumbents didn't have.

Where the users are

LARGEST REPORTED USER BASES (MILLIONS, SELF-REPORTED METRICS VARY)



mixed metrics: customers, MAU, wallets, accounts — each figure cites its source in the directory · colours = wave

The league table is an emerging-market story with a North American accent. **Nubank (131M)** leads the industry outright; WeBank, bKash, OPay, GCash, PalmPay, Maya and TymeBank fill the top tier from Asia, Africa and Latin America. The largest Western players — Cash App, Revolut, Chime — are giants by revenue but mid-table by user count.

Caveat that matters: metrics are self-reported and heterogeneous (customers ≠ MAU ≠ registered wallets), so treat this as magnitude, not ranking. Each figure links to its filing or disclosure in the directory — the standard we'd like the industry itself to adopt.

Five giants, five different machines

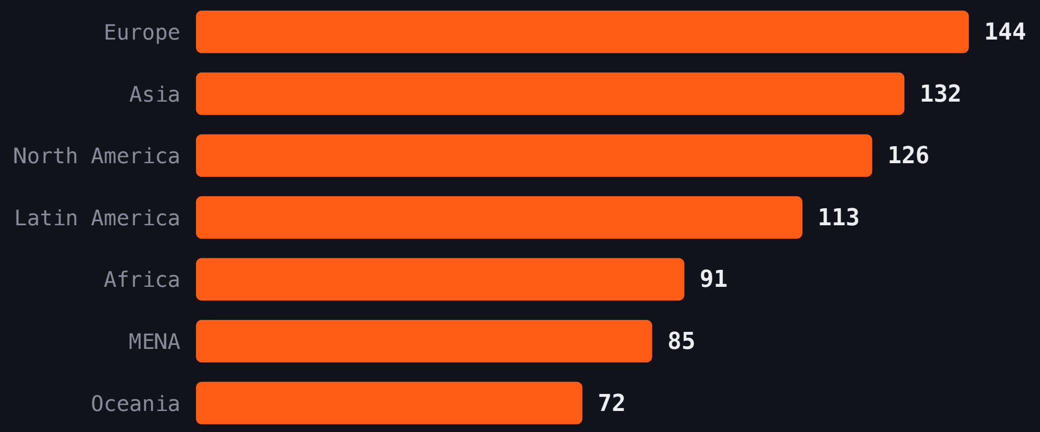
GIANT	REPORTED	THE MACHINE UNDERNEATH
WeBank Shenzhen, CN · est. 2014	400M customers	Distribution-native: born inside the Tencent ecosystem, lending-led, and by most measures the most profitable digital bank on earth.
PhonePe Bengaluru, IN · est. 2015	200M MAU	India's UPI giant — 600M+ registered; wallets, deposits marketplace, insurance.
Nubank São Paulo, BR · est. 2013	131M customers	A licensed bank that made credit cards the wedge into three underbanked markets, then cross-sold everything. The proof that neobanking scales to nine figures profitably.
GCash Manila, PH · est. 2004	94M users	The Philippines' wallet-turned-bank inside a telco ecosystem — remittances, payments and now credit for a diaspora-driven economy.
Mercado Pago Buenos Aires, AR · est. 2003	78M MAU	LatAm super-app; crypto BR/MX; Meli Dollar.

Notice what's absent: not one of the five is a 2010s Western app-first challenger, and not one grew primarily on cashback. All five compounded on **distribution the incumbents didn't have** — credit access, super-app ecosystems, agent networks, telco channels. Scale in this industry has never been won on interface polish; it is won on being the first workable financial rail for a population that lacked one.

> THE WESTERN COUNTER-MODEL
>
> Revolut (65M) is the exception that tests the rule — scaled across 35+ countries on product breadth and FX, now converting that base onto its own banking licenses. Whether breadth can compound like distribution is the most interesting open experiment in wave two.

Seven markets, seven playbooks

ACTIVE PRESENCE BY REGION (MULTI-REGION PLAYERS COUNTED IN EACH)



presence ≠ headquarters — Wise alone is active in six regions · neobankbeat dataset

Europe's 144 is a density record, not a size one: dozens of players per market, aggressive passporting, and the world's most active license regimes. Asia's 132 mixes licensed digital banks (Korea, Singapore, Hong Kong, the Philippines) with wallet giants that became banks in all but name. The following pages profile each region: its model, its champions, and the number that tells its story.

Regional pages list a representative selection; the full per-country view lives in the interactive world map at neobankbeat.com.

Europe

144 ACTIVE NEOBANKS	66 TRADITIONAL	34 HYBRID	44 WEB3-NATIVE

License-dense, margin-thin

The deepest bench of licensed digital banks (Monzo, Starling, bunq, N26) plus the EMI capital of the world. MiCA has made it the clearest jurisdiction for crypto neobanks; profitability, not regulation, is the binding constraint. Watch: euro-stablecoin card programmes scaling under the EMT regime.

SELECTED PLAYERS	HQ	EST.	CUSTODY	REGULATION
Revolut	London, UK	2015	Custodial	Licensed bank
Wise	London, UK	2011	Custodial	E-money institution
Phantom	San Francisco, US	2021	Self-custodial	Self-custodial software
Monzo	London, UK	2015	Custodial	Licensed bank
Zengo	Tel Aviv, IL	2018	MPC	Self-custodial software
Starling Bank	London, UK	2014	Custodial	Licensed bank
Atom Bank	Durham, UK	2014	Custodial	Licensed bank
Zopa Bank	London, UK	2020	Custodial	Licensed bank
Chase UK	London, UK	2021	Custodial	Partner-bank model
Kroo	London, UK	2016	Custodial	Licensed bank
Tide	London, UK	2015	Custodial	E-money institution
ANNA Money	Cardiff, UK	2017	Custodial	E-money institution
OakNorth	London, UK	2015	Custodial	Licensed bank
Allica Bank	Milton Keynes, UK	2019	Custodial	Licensed bank
Curve	London, UK	2015	Custodial	E-money institution
Zempler Bank	London, UK	2005	Custodial	Licensed bank

selection = largest reported user bases + representative sample · full list in Appendix A and at neobankbeat.com/?map=EU

Asia

132	66	23	43
ACTIVE NEOBANKS	TRADITIONAL	HYBRID	WEB3-NATIVE

Licensed giants & superapp gravity

KakaoBank and Toss Bank turned messaging distribution into top-tier banks; Singapore and Hong Kong minted purpose-built digital licenses (GXS, MariBank, ZA, Mox); the Philippines and Indonesia run wallet-first (GCash, Maya, DANA). The scale ceiling here is national population, and it is high.

SELECTED PLAYERS	HQ	EST.	CUSTODY	REGULATION
WeBank	Shenzhen, CN	2014	Custodial	Licensed bank
PhonePe	Bengaluru, IN	2015	Custodial	E-money institution
GCash	Manila, PH	2004	Custodial	E-money institution
bKash	Dhaka, BD	2011	Custodial	Licensed bank
Revolut	London, UK	2015	Custodial	Licensed bank
Maya	Manila, PH	2022	Custodial	Licensed bank
KakaoBank	Seongnam, KR	2016	Custodial	Licensed bank
Wise	London, UK	2011	Custodial	E-money institution
Toss Bank	Seoul, KR	2021	Custodial	Licensed bank
K bank	Seoul, KR	2016	Custodial	Licensed bank
MYbank	Hangzhou, CN	2015	Custodial	Licensed bank
Jupiter	Mumbai, IN	2019	Custodial	Partner-bank model
Niyo	Bengaluru, IN	2015	Custodial	Partner-bank model
slice	Bengaluru, IN	2016	Custodial	Licensed bank
Freo	Bengaluru, IN	2015	Custodial	Partner-bank model
Open	Bengaluru, IN	2017	Custodial	Partner-bank model

selection = largest reported user bases + representative sample · full list in Appendix A and at neobankbeat.com/?map=AS

North America

126	46	38	42
ACTIVE NEOBANKS	TRADITIONAL	HYBRID	WEB3-NATIVE

Partner-bank capital of the world

The US model: tech company in front, sponsor bank behind — Chime, Current, Dave, Mercury, Brex. Post-Synapse, direct bank integration became the trust differentiator; post-GENIUS, the stablecoin question moved from whether to when. Canada runs a small licensed cluster (EQ, Neo, KOHO, Wealthsimple).

SELECTED PLAYERS	HQ	EST.	CUSTODY	REGULATION
Cash App	Oakland, US	2013	Custodial	VASP / MSB / crypto licenses
Revolut	London, UK	2015	Custodial	Licensed bank
Chime	San Francisco, US	2013	Custodial	Partner-bank model
Wise	London, UK	2011	Custodial	E-money institution
Phantom	San Francisco, US	2021	Self-custodial	Self-custodial software
Zengo	Tel Aviv, IL	2018	MPC	Self-custodial software
Varo	San Francisco, US	2015	Custodial	Licensed bank
Current	New York, US	2015	Custodial	Partner-bank model
SoFi	San Francisco, US	2011	Custodial	Licensed bank
Ally Bank	Detroit, US	2009	Custodial	Licensed bank
Dave	Los Angeles, US	2016	Custodial	Partner-bank model
MoneyLion	New York, US	2013	Custodial	Partner-bank model
One	Sacramento, US	2019	Custodial	Partner-bank model
Marcus	New York, US	2016	Custodial	Licensed bank
Step	Palo Alto, US	2018	Custodial	Partner-bank model
Greenlight	Atlanta, US	2014	Custodial	Partner-bank model

selection = largest reported user bases + representative sample · full list in Appendix A and at neobankbeat.com/?map=NA

Latin America

113	32	36	45
ACTIVE NEOBANKS	TRADITIONAL	HYBRID	WEB3-NATIVE

The Nubank effect

The region that proved neobanking at civilisational scale: Nubank (131M), Mercado Pago, PicPay, PagBank, plus strong national champions (Ualá, Klar, Stori, Nequi, Daviplata). Default-yield accounts are table stakes; dollar-stablecoin demand (DolarApp, El Dorado, Lemon) is the fastest-moving frontier.

SELECTED PLAYERS	HQ	EST.	CUSTODY	REGULATION
Nubank	São Paulo, BR	2013	Custodial	Licensed bank
Mercado Pago	Buenos Aires, AR	2003	Custodial	License pending (partner model today)
PicPay	São Paulo, BR	2012	Custodial	Licensed bank
Revolut	London, UK	2015	Custodial	Licensed bank
Banco Inter	Belo Horizonte, BR	2015	Custodial	Licensed bank
PagBank	São Paulo, BR	2019	Custodial	Licensed bank
Nequi	Medellín, CO	2016	Custodial	Licensed bank
Wise	London, UK	2011	Custodial	E-money institution
Ualá	Buenos Aires, AR	2017	Custodial	Licensed bank
Plata	Mexico City, MX	2023	Custodial	Licensed bank
albo	Mexico City, MX	2016	Custodial	Licensed bank
Klar	Mexico City, MX	2019	Custodial	Licensed bank
Stori	Mexico City, MX	2018	Custodial	Licensed bank
Fondeadora	Mexico City, MX	2018	Custodial	Licensed bank
Hey Banco	Monterrey, MX	2018	Custodial	Licensed bank
Cuenca	Mexico City, MX	2018	Custodial	Licensed bank

selection = largest reported user bases + representative sample · full list in Appendix A and at neobankbeat.com/?map=LA

Africa

91	25	25	41
ACTIVE NEOBANKS	TRADITIONAL	HYBRID	WEB3-NATIVE

Payments first, banking second

Agent networks and mobile money built the rails; neobanking is being layered on top. Nigeria is the epicentre — OPay and PalmPay at mass scale, Moniepoint as SMB backbone, Kuda on a microfinance license. TymeBank (SA) proved kiosk+app hybrid onboarding; francophone West Africa (Djamo, Wave) is the next density play.

SELECTED PLAYERS	HQ	EST.	CUSTODY	REGULATION
OPay	Lagos, NG	2018	Custodial	Payment institution
PalmPay	Lagos, NG	2019	Custodial	Payment institution
Wise	London, UK	2011	Custodial	E-money institution
Phantom	San Francisco, US	2021	Self-custodial	Self-custodial software
TymeBank	Johannesburg, ZA	2018	Custodial	Licensed bank
MiniPay	Oslo, NO	2023	Self-custodial	Self-custodial software
Zengo	Tel Aviv, IL	2018	MPC	Self-custodial software
Bank Zero	Johannesburg, ZA	2018	Custodial	Licensed bank
Discovery Bank	Johannesburg, ZA	2019	Custodial	Licensed bank
Kuda	Lagos, NG	2019	Custodial	Licensed bank
Moniepoint	Lagos, NG	2015	Custodial	Other / mixed
FairMoney	Lagos, NG	2017	Custodial	Licensed bank
Carbon	Lagos, NG	2012	Custodial	Licensed bank
ALAT by Wema	Lagos, NG	2017	Custodial	Licensed bank
Sparkle	Lagos, NG	2019	Custodial	Licensed bank
Umba	Lagos/Nairobi	2018	Custodial	Partner-bank model

selection = largest reported user bases + representative sample · full list in Appendix A and at neobankbeat.com/?map=AF

MENA

85	22	24	39
ACTIVE NEOBANKS	TRADITIONAL	HYBRID	WEB3-NATIVE

Regulator-minted digital banks

The Gulf hands out purpose-built licenses (D360, Vision Bank, Zand, Wio, stc bank) with sovereign capital behind them; Egypt banks the informal economy (Khazna, MNT-Halan, Telda); Türkiye runs bank-backed super-wallets (Enpara, Papara). Islamic digital banking is the structural niche with global export potential.

SELECTED PLAYERS	HQ	EST.	CUSTODY	REGULATION
Wise	London, UK	2011	Custodial	E-money institution
Phantom	San Francisco, US	2021	Self-custodial	Self-custodial software
Zengo	Tel Aviv, IL	2018	MPC	Self-custodial software
Telda	Cairo, EG	2021	Custodial	Other / mixed
Wio Bank	Abu Dhabi, AE	2022	Custodial	Licensed bank
Zand	Dubai, AE	2022	Custodial	Licensed bank
YAP	Dubai, AE	2021	Custodial	Partner-bank model
Liv.	Dubai, AE	2017	Custodial	Licensed bank
Pyypl	Dubai, AE	2017	Custodial	Payment institution
NOW Money	Dubai, AE	2016	Custodial	E-money institution
Sarwa	Dubai, AE	2017	Custodial	Broker-led
ila Bank	Manama, BH	2019	Custodial	Licensed bank
Tweeq	Riyadh, SA	2022	Custodial	E-money institution
STC Bank	Riyadh, SA	2018	Custodial	Licensed bank
D360 Bank	Riyadh, SA	2023	Custodial	Licensed bank
Weyay	Kuwait City, KW	2021	Custodial	Licensed bank

selection = largest reported user bases + representative sample · full list in Appendix A and at neobankbeat.com/?map=ME

Oceania

72	8	24	40
ACTIVE NEOBANKS	TRADITIONAL	HYBRID	WEB3-NATIVE

Small market, sharp lessons

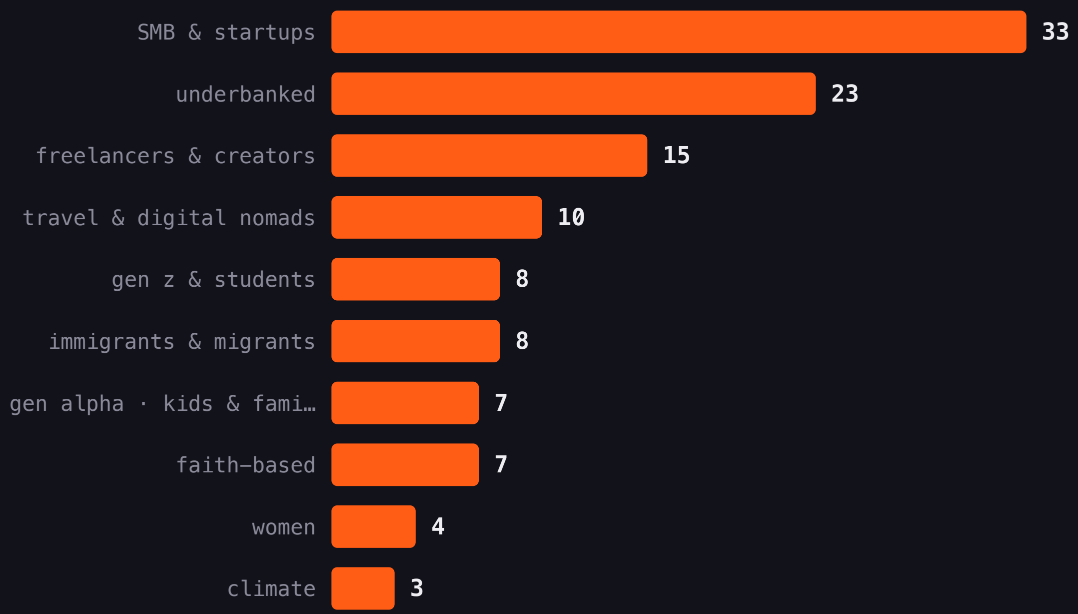
Australia's neobank experiment consolidated hard (Up thriving inside Bendigo; Judo profitable in SMB lending; Volt and Xinja gone) — proof that licenses without unit economics don't survive. NZ's Hnry exports the most interesting freelancer-banking model anywhere.

SELECTED PLAYERS	HQ	EST.	CUSTODY	REGULATION
Revolut	London, UK	2015	Custodial	Licensed bank
Wise	London, UK	2011	Custodial	E-money institution
Phantom	San Francisco, US	2021	Self-custodial	Self-custodial software
Zengo	Tel Aviv, IL	2018	MPC	Self-custodial software
Up	Melbourne, AU	2018	Custodial	Partner-bank model
Judo Bank	Melbourne, AU	2016	Custodial	Licensed bank
Hnry	Wellington, NZ	2017	Custodial	Partner-bank model
Crypto.com	Singapore, SG	2016	Custodial	MiCA CASP (EU)
Binance Card	—	2017	Custodial	VASP / MSB / crypto licenses
Bybit Card	Dubai, AE	2018	Custodial	VASP / MSB / crypto licenses
OKX Card	—	2017	Custodial	MiCA CASP (EU)
Bitget Card	—	2018	Custodial	VASP / MSB / crypto licenses
KuCard	—	2017	Custodial	MiCA CASP (EU)
CEX.IO Card	London, UK	2013	Custodial	VASP / MSB / crypto licenses
CoinJar	Melbourne, AU	2013	Custodial	Payment institution
Strike	Chicago, US	2019	Custodial	VASP / MSB / crypto licenses

selection = largest reported user bases + representative sample · full list in Appendix A and at neobankbeat.com/?map=OC

One in three picks an audience first

126 NICHE-FIRST NEOBANKS BY AUDIENCE



audience as positioned by the provider · neobankbeat dataset

The niche wave is the industry's quiet consensus that "better bank for everyone" is over as a venture pitch. Three structural reasons: **acquisition cost** (communities beat ad auctions), **genuinely different product surface** (Sharia compliance, freelancer tax filing, parental controls are products, not skins), and **underwriting edge** (serving the niche *is* the moat — Zolve underwrites new US arrivals on home-country credit history that generic banks can't read).

The three niches we'd watch hardest: **faith-based** (7 tracked, from UK startups to Gulf licensed banks — a structurally underserved market measured in hundreds of millions), **immigrant banking** (9 tracked — a remittance business wearing a checking account, converging fast with stablecoin rails), and **kids & family** (8 tracked — a two-decade customer-acquisition play whose retention thesis remains unproven).

The full niche map

AUDIENCE	N	REPRESENTATIVE PLAYERS	THE STRUCTURAL EDGE
SMB & startups	33	Mercury, Brex, Ramp	Audience-specific underwriting or compliance edge
underbanked	23	Pockit, Suits Me, Nickel	First-rail economics — no incumbent to displace
freelancers & creators	15	Found, Lili, Karat	Audience-specific underwriting or compliance edge
travel & digital nomads	10	Wise, Global66, Niyo	Audience-specific underwriting or compliance edge
gen z & students	8	Step, imagin, NG.cash	CAC via social distribution; monetisation bet deferred to graduation
immigrants & migrants	8	Majority, Zolve, Comun	Audience-specific underwriting or compliance edge
gen alpha · kids & family	7	Greenlight, Copper, Till Financial	Audience-specific underwriting or compliance edge
faith-based	7	Algbra, Kestrl, Wahed	Compliance (Sharia screening) is binary — you serve it or you don't
women	4	Ellevest, First Women's Bank, Mahila Money	Audience-specific underwriting or compliance edge
climate	3	Tandem Bank, Tomorrow, Flowe	Audience-specific underwriting or compliance edge
seniors	2	True Link, Charlie	Audience-specific underwriting or compliance edge
Black community	2	Greenwood, MoCaFi	Audience-specific underwriting or compliance edge
gig workers	1	Branch	Audience-specific underwriting or compliance edge
healthcare pros	1	Panacea Financial	Audience-specific underwriting or compliance edge
disabilities	1	Purple	Audience-specific underwriting or compliance edge
LGBTQ+	1	Pride Bank	Audience-specific underwriting or compliance edge

representative players = first entries per niche in the dataset; full filterable lists at neobankbeat.com/?niche=...

The industry's broken paper trail

714	113	60	53
OUTBOUND URLS AUDITED	LEGAL LINKS FOUND DEAD	REPAIRED TO LIVE DOCUMENTS	REMOVED AS UNRESOLVABLE

In preparing the dataset behind this report we audited every outbound URL — official sites, terms of service, privacy policies, registers. The result is a small case study in industry hygiene: **113 legal-document links returned hard 404s**. Sixty could be repaired by locating the moved document on the same domain; fifty-three resolve nowhere we could verify, and were removed under our no-guessed-links rule.

Why it matters beyond pedantry: the terms document is where the actual custody and insurance arrangement lives — the difference between "FDIC insured" as legal fact and as vibe. An industry that moves its legal documents without redirects, or removes them entirely, is an industry whose fine print effectively expires. Of 379 tracked entities, only **145 currently carry a verified, live terms link**.

A STANDING OFFER

Any neobank that maintains stable, linkable legal documents gets them verified in the directory within days — issue templates at github.com/andreolf/neobankbeat.

The stories that will write the next editions

Everything before this page is measurement. This chapter is the map of narratives we expect to shape the dataset over the next 24 months — each paired, in the table overleaf, with the signal that will tell us whether it's real. All of it is editorial judgment; treat accordingly.

01 · Agentic commerce: the customer that is software

AI agents are acquiring the ability to hold value and spend it — self-custodial smart accounts, contract-enforced spending limits, and machine-payable HTTP (the x402 pattern: a server answers `402 Payment Required`, the agent pays in stablecoins, the resource unlocks). This creates a customer category that cannot pass a selfie check but can transact millions of times a day. The first neobank-shaped products for machines — balances, limits, statements, controls, but for a fleet of agents — are a matter of quarters, not years. The strategic question for every custodial player: your compliance stack is built to identify humans; who underwrites a language model with a wallet?

02 · Stablecoin payroll and the invisible dollar account

The LatAm dollar-account apps proved demand for holding wages in digital dollars. The next step is upstream: salaries, contractor payouts and creator earnings settling directly in stablecoins, with the neobank reduced to a beautiful interface over a token balance. Remittance-heavy corridors (the immigrant-banking niche of chapter 11) get there first because the pain is measured in percentage points per transfer.

03 · Tokenized deposits: the empire banks back

The incumbent answer to stablecoins is not "no" — it is deposits that settle like tokens while remaining insured bank money. If tokenized-deposit networks reach consumer rails, the neat stablecoin-vs-deposit boundary this report relies on starts to blur, and wave one gets a path to programmable money that never leaves the regulated perimeter.

04 · The neobank as protocol

Wave three's logical endpoint: the "account" is a smart contract standard, cards and IBANs are interchangeable modules from regulated partners, and the app is just one of many front-ends. Gnosis Pay already works this way — the card rail is a platform other wallets plug into. If that pattern spreads, this directory's unit of analysis shifts from companies to *stacks*.

05 · AI-native banking: the interface dissolves

Chat-first money management is the shallow version. The deep version is delegation: an agent that idles your balance into yield, times FX, disputes fees and switches providers — the neobank's relationship moving from "user opens app" to "agent negotiates with API". Loyalty, the industry's scarcest asset, becomes a parameter in someone else's optimiser.

06 · Identity without documents

Passkeys killed the password; zero-knowledge credentials aim at the passport upload — proving "over 18, sanctioned-list-clear, EU resident" without revealing anything else. If regulators accept selective disclosure, the KYC/no-KYC binary of chapter 8 becomes a spectrum, and the card-only bucket becomes the default architecture.

NARRATIVE	THE SIGNAL WE'LL TRACK IN THIS DATASET	STATUS, JULY 2026
Agentic commerce	First entities with agent-specific products; x402-payable services	precursors only (14 no-KYC self-custodial apps)
Stablecoin payroll	Payroll/payout features in the immigrant & freelancer niches	early (8 immigrant-focused players)
Tokenized deposits	Licensed banks (92 tracked) shipping token-settled consumer money	pilots, no consumer rails yet
Neobank as protocol	Multiple front-ends sharing one card/account rail	live (Gnosis Pay partners)
AI-native banking	Agent/automation features as primary interface	chat assistants only
Identity without documents	First zk-credential onboarding accepted by a card programme	not yet observed

> HOW TO READ THIS CHAPTER
>
> Narratives are hypotheses, not findings. Each future edition re-scores this table — publicly, against the same signals — so being wrong will at least be legible.

What we're watching into August

01 · The traditional-wave stablecoin flip

The 2.7% number is the one to re-check monthly. Watch announcements-to-launch conversion, and which partner banks let US neobanks touch supervised stablecoins first.

02 · MiCA grandfathering endgame

As national transition windows close, expect a visible sorting: authorised CASPs consolidating European volume, and a quiet exit tail. Register entries beat press releases.

03 · Self-custody UX unlock

Passkey wallets, MPC recovery and smart-account cards are converging on "self-custody that feels like an app". Each release chips at the biggest objection to wave three.

04 · Agent wallets

Software agents that hold keys and spend within contract-enforced limits are the strangest new constituency in the dataset — and the first genuinely new "customer type" since teenagers got debit cards. We expect the first mainstream agent-payments controversy within twelve months. *(Speculative, flagged.)*

05 · The niche graveyard's next entries

Niche banking works until the niche's unit economics don't. Watch subscription-dependent kids' banks and thin-margin travel cards as funding stays tight.

NEXT EDITION

The State of Neobanks — September 2026 ships early next month: same method, fresh data, deltas tracked against this edition. Subscribe at neobankbeat.substack.com.

How the sausage is measured

Inclusion pipeline

1. **Intake:** candidates arrive via public GitHub issue templates, our own monitoring, and reader submissions to the newsletter.
2. **Liveness check:** product must be verifiably live and onboarding — an app-store listing with recent releases, a working sign-up, or a register entry plus active status. Waitlists and "coming soon" don't count.
3. **Scope check:** consumer/SMB money app with everyday-banking ambition. We exclude pure infrastructure (BaaS, issuer-processors), trading-only apps, and superapp payment features without a banking surface.
4. **Field verification:** each field is sourced independently — registers for licenses, terms documents for custody arrangements, filings for user counts. Unverifiable fields stay null.
5. **Continuous review:** link-rot audits (chapter 12), monthly liveness re-checks on a rotating cohort, and removal on confirmed shutdown.

Known limitations — read before quoting

- **Survivorship by design:** founding-year charts describe today's industry's origins, not historical founding rates.
- **Presence ≠ market share:** regional counts weight Wise's six-region footprint equally with a single-country app.
- **Self-reported scale:** user figures mix customers, MAU and registered wallets; we preserve each source's metric rather than harmonising by guesswork.
- **Classification judgment:** wave and regulation labels involve edge calls (chapter 1's "categories are dissolving" finding cuts both ways). Disagreements are adjudicated in public via GitHub issues.
- **Coverage bias:** English-language and register-covered markets surface faster; we assume undercounting in Central Asia, francophone Africa and parts of LatAm.

CORRECTIONS

Found an error? File a data-fix issue at github.com/andreolf/neobankbeat — corrections land in the dataset within days and in the next month's edition, credited.

—— APPENDIX A · ALL 379 TRACKED NEOBANKS (1–34)

NAME	WAVE	HQ	EST.	CUSTODY	STABLES	KYC
Airtm	H	Mexico City, MX	2015	Custodial	yes	Yes
Belo	H	Buenos Aires, AR	2020	Custodial	yes	Yes
BFinance	H	Prague, CZ	2023	Custodial	yes	Yes
Binance Card	H	—	2017	Custodial	yes	Yes
Bitget Card	H	—	2018	Custodial	yes	Yes
Bitnob	H	Lagos, NG	2020	Custodial	yes	Yes
Bitpanda	H	Vienna, AT	2014	Custodial	yes	Yes
BitPay Card	H	Atlanta, US	2011	Custodial	yes	Yes
Bitso	H	Mexico City, MX	2014	Custodial	yes	Yes
Brighty	H	Baar (Zug), CH	2021	Custodial	yes	Yes
Brookwell	H	New York, US	2025	Custodial	yes	Yes
Buenbit	H	Buenos Aires, AR	2018	Custodial	yes	Yes
Bybit Card	H	Dubai, AE	2018	Custodial	yes	Yes
Cash App	H	Oakland, US	2013	Custodial	—	Yes
CEX.IO Card	H	London, UK	2013	Custodial	yes	Yes
Chipper Cash	H	San Francisco, US	2018	Custodial	yes	Yes
COCA	H	Dubai, AE	2023	MPC	yes	Yes
Coinbase Card	H	San Francisco, US	2012	Custodial	yes	Yes
CoinJar	H	Melbourne, AU	2013	Custodial	yes	Yes
Crypto.com	H	Singapore, SG	2016	Custodial	yes	Yes
Deel	H	San Francisco, US	2019	Custodial	yes	Yes
Dolafy	H	Brazil, BR	2025	Custodial	yes	Yes
DolarApp	H	Mexico City, MX	2021	Custodial	yes	Yes
eToro Money	H	Tel Aviv, IL	2007	Custodial	yes	Yes
Fasset	H	Dubai, AE	2019	Custodial	yes	Yes
Félix	H	Mexico City, MX	2022	Custodial	yes	Yes
Flex	H	San Francisco, US	2022	Custodial	yes	Yes
Fold	H	Phoenix, US	2019	Custodial	—	Yes
Gemini Credit Card	H	New York, US	2014	Custodial	yes	Yes
KAST	H	Hong Kong, HK	2024	Custodial	yes	Yes
Kolo	H	—	2022	Custodial	yes	Yes
Krak	H	San Francisco, US	2025	Custodial	yes	Yes
KuCard	H	—	2017	Custodial	yes	Yes
Lava	H	New York, US	2022	Custodial	yes	Yes

—— APPENDIX A · ALL 379 TRACKED NEOBANKS (35–68)

NAME	WAVE	HQ	EST.	CUSTODY	STABLES	KYC
Lemon	H	Buenos Aires, AR	2019	Custodial	yes	Yes
Littio	H	Bogotá, CO	2021	Custodial	yes	Yes
Meow	H	New York, US	2021	Custodial	yes	Yes
Mercado Pago	H	Buenos Aires, AR	2003	Custodial	yes	Yes
Meru	H	Bogotá, CO	2021	Custodial	yes	Yes
Mogo	H	Vancouver, CA	2003	Custodial	—	Yes
Nexo	H	Zug, CH	2018	Custodial	yes	Yes
OKX Card	H	—	2017	Custodial	yes	Yes
Plutus	H	London, UK	2015	Custodial	—	Yes
RedotPay	H	Hong Kong, HK	2023	Custodial	yes	Yes
Revolut	H	London, UK	2015	Custodial	yes	Yes
Ripio	H	Buenos Aires, AR	2013	Custodial	yes	Yes
Robinhood	H	Menlo Park, US	2013	Custodial	yes	Yes
Slash	H	San Francisco, US	2021	Custodial	yes	Yes
SpectroCoin	H	Vilnius, LT	2013	Custodial	yes	Yes
Strike	H	Chicago, US	2019	Custodial	yes	Yes
Takenos	H	Buenos Aires, AR	2022	Custodial	yes	Yes
Tap Global	H	London, UK	2018	Custodial	yes	Yes
Trustee Plus	H	Vilnius, LT	2019	Custodial	yes	Yes
Uphold	H	New York, US	2015	Custodial	yes	Yes
UR	H	—	2023	Custodial	yes	Yes
Venmo	H	New York, US	2009	Custodial	yes	Yes
Wirex	H	London, UK	2014	Custodial	yes	Yes
Xapo Bank	H	Gibraltar	2013	Custodial	yes	Yes
XPlace	H	Dubai, AE	2023	Custodial	yes	Yes
Yellow Card	H	Lagos, NG	2016	Custodial	yes	Yes
Yuh	H	Gland, CH	2021	Custodial	—	Yes
AEON Bank	T	Kuala Lumpur, MY	2023	Custodial	—	Yes
Airtel Payments Bank	T	Delhi, IN	2017	Custodial	—	Yes
ALAT by Wema	T	Lagos, NG	2017	Custodial	—	Yes
Albert	T	Culver City, US	2015	Custodial	—	Yes
albo	T	Mexico City, MX	2016	Custodial	—	Yes
Algbra	T	London, UK	2020	Custodial	—	Yes
Allica Bank	T	Milton Keynes, UK	2019	Custodial	—	Yes

—— APPENDIX A · ALL 379 TRACKED NEOBANKS (69–102)

NAME	WAVE	HQ	EST.	CUSTODY	STABLES	KYC
Allo Bank	T	Jakarta, ID	2021	Custodial	—	Yes
Ally Bank	T	Detroit, US	2009	Custodial	—	Yes
Alpian	T	Geneva, CH	2019	Custodial	—	Yes
Always.bank	T	Birmingham, US	2025	Custodial	—	Yes
AMP Bank GO	T	Sydney, AU	2025	Custodial	—	Yes
ANEXT Bank	T	Singapore, SG	2022	Custodial	—	Yes
ANNA Money	T	Cardiff, UK	2017	Custodial	—	Yes
Aspire	T	Singapore, SG	2018	Custodial	—	Yes
Atom Bank	T	Durham, UK	2014	Custodial	—	Yes
Banco Inter	T	Belo Horizonte, BR	2015	Custodial	—	Yes
Bank Jago	T	Jakarta, ID	2020	Custodial	—	Yes
Bank Zero	T	Johannesburg, ZA	2018	Custodial	—	Yes
Baraka	T	Dubai, AE	2021	Custodial	—	Yes
Beyon Money	T	Manama, BH	2022	Custodial	—	Yes
bKash	T	Dhaka, BD	2011	Custodial	—	Yes
Bling	T	Berlin, DE	2021	Custodial	—	Yes
Blink	T	Amman, JO	2022	Custodial	—	Yes
Blu by BCA	T	Jakarta, ID	2021	Custodial	—	Yes
Bluevine	T	Redwood City, US	2013	Custodial	—	Yes
Boost Bank	T	Kuala Lumpur, MY	2024	Custodial	—	Yes
BoursoBank	T	Paris, FR	1995	Custodial	—	Yes
Branch	T	Minneapolis, US	2015	Custodial	—	Yes
Branch Intl	T	Nairobi/Lagos	2015	Custodial	—	Yes
Brex	T	San Francisco, US	2017	Custodial	—	Yes
Brubank	T	Buenos Aires, AR	2017	Custodial	—	Yes
buddybank	T	Milan, IT	2018	Custodial	—	Yes
bunq	T	Amsterdam, NL	2012	Custodial	—	Yes
C24 Bank	T	Frankfurt, DE	2020	Custodial	—	Yes
C6 Bank	T	São Paulo, BR	2019	Custodial	—	Yes
Cake	T	Ho Chi Minh, VN	2021	Custodial	—	Yes
Carbon	T	Lagos, NG	2012	Custodial	—	Yes
Charlie	T	Los Angeles, US	2022	Custodial	—	Yes
Chase UK	T	London, UK	2021	Custodial	—	Yes
Chime	T	San Francisco, US	2013	Custodial	—	Yes

—— APPENDIX A · ALL 379 TRACKED NEOBANKS (103–136)

NAME	WAVE	HQ	EST.	CUSTODY	STABLES	KYC
Cleva	T	Lagos, NG	2023	Custodial	—	Yes
Comun	T	New York, US	2021	Custodial	—	Yes
Copper	T	Seattle, US	2019	Custodial	—	Yes
Cora	T	São Paulo, BR	2019	Custodial	—	Yes
Cuenca	T	Mexico City, MX	2018	Custodial	—	Yes
Current	T	New York, US	2015	Custodial	—	Yes
Curve	T	London, UK	2015	Custodial	—	Yes
D360 Bank	T	Riyadh, SA	2023	Custodial	—	Yes
DANA	T	Jakarta, ID	2018	Custodial	—	Yes
Dave	T	Los Angeles, US	2016	Custodial	—	Yes
Daviplata	T	Bogotá, CO	2011	Custodial	—	Yes
Discovery Bank	T	Johannesburg, ZA	2019	Custodial	—	Yes
Djamo	T	Abidjan, CI	2019	Custodial	—	Yes
Douugh	T	Sydney, AU	2016	Custodial	—	Yes
Ellevest	T	New York, US	2014	Custodial	—	Yes
Enpara	T	Istanbul, TR	2012	Custodial	—	Yes
EQ Bank	T	Toronto, CA	2016	Custodial	—	Yes
Esh Bank	T	Tel Aviv, IL	2022	Custodial	—	Yes
Eversend	T	Kampala/Paris	2017	Custodial	—	Yes
FairMoney	T	Lagos, NG	2017	Custodial	—	Yes
FamPay	T	Bengaluru, IN	2019	Custodial	—	Yes
Fingo	T	Nairobi, KE	2021	Custodial	—	Yes
Finom	T	Amsterdam, NL	2019	Custodial	—	Yes
First Women's Bank	T	Chicago, US	2021	Custodial	—	Yes
Flouci	T	Tunis, TN	2018	Custodial	—	Yes
Flowe	T	Milan, IT	2020	Custodial	—	Yes
Fondeadora	T	Mexico City, MX	2018	Custodial	—	Yes
Fortuneo	T	Brest, FR	2000	Custodial	—	Yes
Found	T	San Francisco, US	2019	Custodial	—	Yes
Freo	T	Bengaluru, IN	2015	Custodial	—	Yes
Fyrst	T	Bonn, DE	2019	Custodial	—	Yes
GCash	T	Manila, PH	2004	Custodial	—	Yes
Global66	T	Santiago, CL	2018	Custodial	—	Yes
GoHenry	T	New York/London	2012	Custodial	—	Yes

—— APPENDIX A · ALL 379 TRACKED NEOBANKS (137–170)

NAME	WAVE	HQ	EST.	CUSTODY	STABLES	KYC
GoPay	T	Jakarta, ID	2016	Custodial	—	Yes
GoTyme Bank	T	Manila, PH	2022	Custodial	—	Yes
GrabPay	T	Singapore, SG	2016	Custodial	—	Yes
Grasshopper	T	New York, US	2019	Custodial	—	Yes
Greenlight	T	Atlanta, US	2014	Custodial	—	Yes
Greenwood	T	Atlanta, US	2020	Custodial	—	Yes
Grey	T	Lagos, NG	2020	Custodial	—	Yes
GXBank	T	Kuala Lumpur, MY	2023	Custodial	—	Yes
GXS Bank	T	Singapore, SG	2022	Custodial	—	Yes
Haventree Bank	T	Toronto, CA	2018	Custodial	—	Yes
Hello bank!	T	Paris, FR	2013	Custodial	—	Yes
Hey Banco	T	Monterrey, MX	2018	Custodial	—	Yes
Hnry	T	Wellington, NZ	2017	Custodial	—	Yes
Hype	T	Milan, IT	2015	Custodial	—	Yes
ila Bank	T	Manama, BH	2019	Custodial	—	Yes
imagin	T	Barcelona, ES	2020	Custodial	—	Yes
indó	T	Reykjavík, IS	2018	Custodial	—	Yes
Indy	T	Lyon, FR	2016	Custodial	—	Yes
isybank	T	Milan, IT	2023	Custodial	—	Yes
Jenius	T	Jakarta, ID	2016	Custodial	—	Yes
Jio Payments Bank	T	Mumbai, IN	2018	Custodial	—	Yes
Judo Bank	T	Melbourne, AU	2016	Custodial	—	Yes
Jupiter	T	Mumbai, IN	2019	Custodial	—	Yes
K bank	T	Seoul, KR	2016	Custodial	—	Yes
KakaoBank	T	Seongnam, KR	2016	Custodial	—	Yes
Karat	T	Los Angeles, US	2019	Custodial	—	Yes
Kaspi	T	Almaty, KZ	2012	Custodial	—	Yes
Kestrl	T	London, UK	2019	Custodial	—	Yes
Khazna	T	Cairo, EG	2020	Custodial	—	Yes
Kit	T	Sydney, AU	2022	Custodial	—	Yes
Klar	T	Mexico City, MX	2019	Custodial	—	Yes
Klarna	T	Stockholm, SE	2005	Custodial	—	Yes
KOHO	T	Toronto, CA	2014	Custodial	—	Yes
Kontist	T	Berlin, DE	2016	Custodial	—	Yes

—— APPENDIX A · ALL 379 TRACKED NEOBANKS (171–204)

NAME	WAVE	HQ	EST.	CUSTODY	STABLES	KYC
Kroo	T	London, UK	2016	Custodial	—	Yes
Kuda	T	Lagos, NG	2019	Custodial	—	Yes
Lili	T	New York, US	2018	Custodial	—	Yes
LINE Bank TW	T	Taipei, TW	2021	Custodial	—	Yes
LINE BK	T	Bangkok, TH	2020	Custodial	—	Yes
Liv.	T	Dubai, AE	2017	Custodial	—	Yes
Lulo Bank	T	Bogotá, CO	2021	Custodial	—	Yes
Lunar	T	Aarhus, DK	2015	Custodial	—	Yes
Mahila Money	T	Delhi, IN	2021	Custodial	—	Yes
Majority	T	Houston, US	2019	Custodial	—	Yes
Marcus	T	New York, US	2016	Custodial	—	Yes
MariBank	T	Singapore, SG	2022	Custodial	—	Yes
Mashreq Neo	T	Dubai, AE	2017	Custodial	—	Yes
Maya	T	Manila, PH	2022	Custodial	yes	Yes
Mercury	T	San Francisco, US	2017	Custodial	—	Yes
Minna Bank	T	Fukuoka, JP	2021	Custodial	—	Yes
MNT-Halan	T	Cairo, EG	2018	Custodial	—	Yes
MoCaFi	T	New York, US	2016	Custodial	—	Yes
MoMo	T	Ho Chi Minh City, VN	2013	Custodial	—	Yes
Moneco	T	Paris, FR	2022	Custodial	—	Yes
Monese	T	London, UK	2013	Custodial	—	Yes
MoneyLion	T	New York, US	2013	Custodial	—	Yes
Moniepoint	T	Lagos, NG	2015	Custodial	—	Yes
Monobank	T	Kyiv, UA	2017	Custodial	—	Yes
Monzo	T	London, UK	2015	Custodial	—	Yes
Movii	T	Bogotá, CO	2018	Custodial	—	Yes
Mox Bank	T	Hong Kong, HK	2020	Custodial	—	Yes
Munify	T	Cairo, EG	2024	Custodial	—	Yes
MYbank	T	Hangzhou, CN	2015	Custodial	—	Yes
MyInvestor	T	Madrid, ES	2017	Custodial	—	Yes
N26	T	Berlin, DE	2013	Custodial	—	Yes
Nagad	T	Dhaka, BD	2019	Custodial	—	Yes
Naranja X	T	Córdoba, AR	2019	Custodial	—	Yes
NayaPay	T	Karachi, PK	2019	Custodial	—	Yes

—— APPENDIX A · ALL 379 TRACKED NEOBANKS (205–238)

NAME	WAVE	HQ	EST.	CUSTODY	STABLES	KYC
Neo Financial	T	Calgary, CA	2019	Custodial	—	Yes
neon	T	Zurich, CH	2017	Custodial	—	Yes
Neon	T	São Paulo, BR	2016	Custodial	—	Yes
Nequi	T	Medellín, CO	2016	Custodial	—	Yes
NEXT Bank	T	Taipei, TW	2022	Custodial	—	Yes
NG.cash	T	Rio de Janeiro, BR	2021	Custodial	yes	Yes
Nickel	T	Paris, FR	2014	Custodial	—	Yes
Niyo	T	Bengaluru, IN	2015	Custodial	—	Yes
Nomad	T	São Paulo, BR	2019	Custodial	—	Yes
Northmill	T	Stockholm, SE	2006	Custodial	—	Yes
NorthOne	T	New York, US	2016	Custodial	—	Yes
Novo	T	Miami, US	2016	Custodial	—	Yes
NOW Money	T	Dubai, AE	2016	Custodial	—	Yes
Nubank	T	São Paulo, BR	2013	Custodial	—	Yes
Nyla	T	Lagos, NG	2024	Custodial	—	Yes
OakNorth	T	London, UK	2015	Custodial	—	Yes
One	T	Sacramento, US	2019	Custodial	—	Yes
One Zero	T	Tel Aviv, IL	2019	Custodial	—	Yes
OPay	T	Lagos, NG	2018	Custodial	—	Yes
Open	T	Bengaluru, IN	2017	Custodial	—	Yes
Openbank	T	Madrid, ES	1995	Custodial	—	Yes
Oraan	T	Karachi, PK	2018	Custodial	—	Yes
OVO	T	Jakarta, ID	2017	Custodial	—	Yes
PagBank	T	São Paulo, BR	2019	Custodial	—	Yes
PalmPay	T	Lagos, NG	2019	Custodial	—	Yes
Panacea Financial	T	Little Rock, US	2020	Custodial	—	Yes
Papara	T	Istanbul, TR	2016	Custodial	—	Yes
Parpera	T	Sydney, AU	2020	Custodial	—	Yes
PayPay Bank	T	Tokyo, JP	2000	Custodial	—	Yes
Paysera	T	Vilnius, LT	2004	Custodial	—	Yes
PaySika	T	Douala, CM	2020	Custodial	—	Yes
Paytm	T	Noida, IN	2010	Custodial	—	Yes
PhonePe	T	Bengaluru, IN	2015	Custodial	—	Yes
PicPay	T	São Paulo, BR	2012	Custodial	yes	Yes

—— APPENDIX A · ALL 379 TRACKED NEOBANKS (239–272)

NAME	WAVE	HQ	EST.	CUSTODY	STABLES	KYC
Pixpay	T	Paris, FR	2019	Custodial	—	Yes
Plata	T	Mexico City, MX	2023	Custodial	—	Yes
Pockit	T	London, UK	2014	Custodial	—	Yes
Prex	T	Montevideo, UY	2015	Custodial	—	Yes
Pride Bank	T	São Paulo, BR	2019	Custodial	—	Yes
Purple	T	New York, US	2018	Custodial	—	Yes
Pyypl	T	Dubai, AE	2017	Custodial	—	Yes
Qik	T	Santo Domingo, DO	2021	Custodial	—	Yes
Qonto	T	Paris, FR	2016	Custodial	—	Yes
Rakuten Bank	T	Tokyo, JP	2001	Custodial	—	Yes
Ramp	T	New York, US	2019	Custodial	—	Yes
RappiPay	T	Bogotá, CO	2019	Custodial	—	Yes
RazorpayX	T	Bengaluru, IN	2019	Custodial	—	Yes
Relay	T	Toronto/US	2018	Custodial	—	Yes
Rho	T	New York, US	2018	Custodial	—	Yes
Rocker	T	Stockholm, SE	2017	Custodial	—	Yes
Ryt Bank	T	Kuala Lumpur, MY	2025	Custodial	—	Yes
SadaPay	T	Karachi, PK	2019	Custodial	—	Yes
Salt Bank	T	Bucharest, RO	2024	Custodial	—	Yes
Sarwa	T	Dubai, AE	2017	Custodial	—	Yes
SeaBank	T	Jakarta, ID	2021	Custodial	—	Yes
Shine	T	Paris, FR	2017	Custodial	—	Yes
slice	T	Bengaluru, IN	2016	Custodial	—	Yes
Snappi	T	Athens, GR	2024	Custodial	—	Yes
SoFi	T	San Francisco, US	2011	Custodial	yes	Yes
Sony Bank	T	Tokyo, JP	2001	Custodial	—	Yes
Sparkle	T	Lagos, NG	2019	Custodial	—	Yes
Starling Bank	T	London, UK	2014	Custodial	—	Yes
STC Bank	T	Riyadh, SA	2018	Custodial	—	Yes
Step	T	Palo Alto, US	2018	Custodial	—	Yes
Stori	T	Mexico City, MX	2018	Custodial	—	Yes
Suits Me	T	Cheshire, UK	2015	Custodial	—	Yes
Sumeria (Lydia)	T	Paris, FR	2013	Custodial	—	Yes
Superbank	T	Jakarta, ID	2023	Custodial	—	Yes

—— APPENDIX A · ALL 379 TRACKED NEOBANKS (273–306)

NAME	WAVE	HQ	EST.	CUSTODY	STABLES	KYC
T-Bank	T	Moscow, RU	2006	Custodial	—	Yes
Tandem Bank	T	London, UK	2013	Custodial	—	Yes
TBC UZ	T	Tashkent, UZ	2020	Custodial	—	Yes
Telda	T	Cairo, EG	2021	Custodial	—	Yes
Tenpo	T	Santiago, CL	2017	Custodial	yes	Yes
Tide	T	London, UK	2015	Custodial	—	Yes
Till Financial	T	Boston, US	2018	Custodial	—	Yes
Timo	T	Ho Chi Minh, VN	2015	Custodial	—	Yes
Tinaba	T	Milan, IT	2015	Custodial	—	Yes
TNEX	T	Hanoi, VN	2020	Custodial	—	Yes
Tomorrow	T	Hamburg, DE	2018	Custodial	—	Yes
Tonik	T	Manila, PH	2018	Custodial	—	Yes
Toss Bank	T	Seoul, KR	2021	Custodial	—	Yes
Touch 'n Go eWallet	T	Kuala Lumpur, MY	2017	Custodial	—	Yes
Trade Republic	T	Berlin, DE	2015	Custodial	—	Yes
True Link	T	San Francisco, US	2012	Custodial	—	Yes
TrueMoney	T	Bangkok, TH	2003	Custodial	—	Yes
Trust Bank	T	Singapore, SG	2022	Custodial	—	Yes
Tweeq	T	Riyadh, SA	2022	Custodial	—	Yes
TymeBank	T	Johannesburg, ZA	2018	Custodial	—	Yes
Ualá	T	Buenos Aires, AR	2017	Custodial	yes	Yes
ueno bank	T	Asunción, PY	2021	Custodial	—	Yes
Umba	T	Lagos/Nairobi	2018	Custodial	—	Yes
UnionDigital	T	Manila, PH	2022	Custodial	—	Yes
UNO Digital Bank	T	Manila, PH	2021	Custodial	—	Yes
Up	T	Melbourne, AU	2018	Custodial	—	Yes
Uzum	T	Tashkent, UZ	2022	Custodial	—	Yes
Varo	T	San Francisco, US	2015	Custodial	—	Yes
Vision Bank	T	Riyadh, SA	2024	Custodial	—	Yes
Vivid Money	T	Berlin, DE	2019	Custodial	—	Yes
Wahed	T	New York, US	2015	Custodial	—	Yes
Wave	T	Dakar, SN	2018	Custodial	—	Yes
Wealthsimple	T	Toronto, CA	2014	Custodial	—	Yes
WeBank	T	Shenzhen, CN	2014	Custodial	—	Yes

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NAME	WAVE	HQ	EST.	CUSTODY	STABLES	KYC
WeLab Bank	T	Hong Kong, HK	2020	Custodial	—	Yes
Weyay	T	Kuwait City, KW	2021	Custodial	—	Yes
Wio Bank	T	Abu Dhabi, AE	2022	Custodial	—	Yes
Wise	T	London, UK	2011	Custodial	—	Yes
YAP	T	Dubai, AE	2021	Custodial	—	Yes
YouTrip	T	Singapore, SG	2018	Custodial	—	Yes
ZA Bank	T	Hong Kong, HK	2020	Custodial	yes	Yes
Zak	T	Basel, CH	2017	Custodial	—	Yes
ZaloPay	T	Ho Chi Minh City, VN	2016	Custodial	—	Yes
Zand	T	Dubai, AE	2022	Custodial	—	Yes
Zempler Bank	T	London, UK	2005	Custodial	—	Yes
ZEN.com	T	Vilnius, LT	2018	Custodial	—	Yes
Zinli	T	Panama City, PA	2020	Custodial	—	Yes
Zolve	T	New York/Bengaluru	2020	Custodial	—	Yes
Zopa Bank	T	London, UK	2020	Custodial	—	Yes
1inch Card	W	Dubai, AE	2023	Self-custodial	yes	Card only
AllScale	W	—	2024	Custodial	yes	Yes
Avalanche Card	W	—	2024	Self-custodial	yes	Card only
Avici	W	—	2024	Self-custodial	yes	Card only
Bitget Wallet	W	—	2018	Self-custodial	yes	Card only
Bleap	W	London, UK	2024	MPC	yes	Card only
Cypher	W	—	2022	Self-custodial	yes	Card only
Daimo	W	New York, US	2023	Self-custodial	yes	No
Dakota	W	New York, US	2023	Self-custodial	yes	Yes
Deblock	W	Paris, FR	2022	Mixed	yes	Yes
Decaf	W	—	2022	Self-custodial	yes	Card only
Eco (Beam)	W	New York, US	2023	Self-custodial	yes	No
El Dorado	W	—	2022	Self-custodial	yes	Yes
EtherFi Cash	W	Miami, US	2025	Self-custodial	yes	Card only
Exa	W	Buenos Aires, AR	2023	Self-custodial	yes	Card only
Exodus	W	Omaha, US	2015	Self-custodial	yes	No
Fiat24	W	Zurich, CH	2021	Self-custodial	yes	Yes
Fizen	W	Ho Chi Minh, VN	2022	Self-custodial	yes	Card only
Gnosis Pay	W	Zug, CH	2023	Self-custodial	yes	Card only

—— APPENDIX A · ALL 379 TRACKED NEOBANKS (341–374)

NAME	WAVE	HQ	EST.	CUSTODY	STABLES	KYC
Holyheld	W	London, UK	2020	Self-custodial	yes	Card only
Hyperbeat	W	—	2024	Self-custodial	yes	Card only
Infini	W	—	2024	Self-custodial	yes	Card only
Karta	W	Redwood City, US	2020	MPC	yes	Card only
Kontigo	W	—	2024	Custodial	yes	Yes
MetaMask	W	Consensys (global)	2016	Self-custodial	yes	Card only
Mine	W	Zug, CH	2024	Self-custodial	yes	Yes
MiniPay	W	Oslo, NO	2023	Self-custodial	yes	No
Moon	W	—	2022	Self-custodial	yes	No
Moto	W	New York, US	2025	Self-custodial	yes	Card only
Onboard	W	Lagos, NG	2021	Self-custodial	yes	Card only
Oobit	W	Singapore, SG	2017	Self-custodial	yes	Yes
Payy	W	New York, US	2023	Self-custodial	yes	Card only
Peanut	W	Zug, CH	2022	Self-custodial	yes	No
Phantom	W	San Francisco, US	2021	Self-custodial	yes	No
Plasma One	W	—	2025	Self-custodial	yes	Card only
Rainbow	W	New York, US	2019	Self-custodial	yes	No
Ready	W	London, UK	2018	Self-custodial	yes	Card only
Rizon	W	—	2024	Self-custodial	yes	Card only
SafePal	W	Singapore, SG	2018	Self-custodial	yes	Card only
Sling Money	W	London, UK	2023	Self-custodial	yes	Yes
Slush	W	Palo Alto, US	2021	Self-custodial	yes	No
Solayer Emerald	W	—	2024	Self-custodial	yes	Card only
Solflare	W	Belgrade, RS	2017	Self-custodial	yes	Card only
Solid	W	Gibraltar, GI	2025	MPC	yes	Card only
Stables	W	Sydney, AU	2021	Custodial	yes	Yes
Startale	W	Singapore, SG	2023	Self-custodial	yes	Card only
Superform	W	—	2023	Self-custodial	yes	No
SurfCash	W	—	2025	Self-custodial	yes	No
Tangem	W	Zug, CH	2017	Self-custodial	yes	Card only
Tria	W	—	2024	Self-custodial	yes	Card only
Trust Wallet	W	—	2017	Self-custodial	yes	No
Tuyo	W	—	2023	Self-custodial	yes	Card only
UglyCash	W	San Juan, PR	2023	Custodial	yes	Yes

—— APPENDIX A · ALL 379 TRACKED NEOBANKS (375–379)

NAME	WAVE	HQ	EST.	CUSTODY	STABLES	KYC
Veera	W	Singapore, SG	2023	Self-custodial	yes	Card only
WeFi	W	—	2023	Self-custodial	yes	Card only
xPortal	W	Sibiu, RO	2021	Self-custodial	yes	Card only
Xverse	W	London, UK	2021	Self-custodial	yes	No
Zengo	W	Tel Aviv, IL	2018	MPC	yes	No

The dataset behind every number

Everything in this report derives from `neobankbeat.com/data.json` — the machine-readable export of the neobankbeat directory (MIT license). Key fields:

FIELD	MEANING
`category`	traditional · hybrid · web3-native (the three waves)
`custody`	Custodial · Self-custodial · MPC self-custodial · Mixed
`regulation_type`	derived: Licensed bank, Partner-bank model, E-money institution, MiCA CASP (EU), Self-custodial software, …
`kyc`	Yes · No · Card only (permissionless wallet, identified cardholder)
`stablecoins`	any verified stablecoin support: balances, rails, cards or transfers
`cashback / yield`	headline "up to" rates as advertised — not effective rates
`active_regions / countries`	verified operating footprint (presence, not HQ)
`reported_users`	self-reported scale with metric and as-of date; each figure cites its source
`terms_url / privacy_url / x_handle`	verified links only — nulls mean unverifiable, never unknown-guessed

Update cadence: continuous, in the open. Corrections via GitHub issues (data-fix template) are typically resolved within days. The static profile pages at `/n/` and comparisons at `/vs/` regenerate from the same file, so site, dataset and report cannot drift apart.

—— REFERENCES & FURTHER READING

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13. **Court records, In re Synapse Financial Technologies** (C.D. Cal. Bankr., 2024) and contemporaneous coverage — for the pass-through insurance discussion
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Where a chapter states an interpretation rather than a measurement (marked "our reading" or "speculative"), it is the publisher's editorial judgment, not a sourced fact.

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